

שירת הים contains many important topics, with a highlight being שירת הים, beginning with the familiar words we recite daily (15:1): אָז יֵשִׁיר מֹשֶׁה. The מפרשים are struck by the fact that משה רבינו starts the שירה with the word אָז. The מדרש רבה (23:3), as quoted by the בית הלוי, notes: אמר משה באז חטאתי שאמרתי ומאז באתי: אֶל פְּרַעַה לְדַבֵּר בְּשִׁמְךָ הָרַע לָעַם הַזֶּה, באז אני אומר שירה ומאז באתי אֶל פְּרַעַה לְדַבֵּר בְּשִׁמְךָ הָרַע, (5:23), אִזּוֹ, when I said (5:23), אִזּוֹ, I use the same word again, אִזּוֹ. Now when I say שירה, I use the same word again, אִזּוֹ. לָעַם הַזֶּה. משה and other מפרשים explain what משה did wrong. At the very end of פרשת שמות, משה רבינו questioned Hashem, asking why their situation worsened after He had promised redemption. Moshe's טענה was against הקדוש ברוך הוא, but his כוונה was as a defense of ישראל, asking Hashem to please help them. The mistake Moshe made was that we can't question Hashem's judgment as to how he sends a ישועה, and therefore, on his level, it was considered that משה רבינו did an עבירה. The מדרש is saying that somehow, the אִזּוֹ that משה said in אָז יֵשִׁיר was to rectify the אִזּוֹ he said in פרשת שמות. The question arises: How does using אִזּוֹ here rectify the previous אִזּוֹ?

The בית הלוי explains that when someone experiences צער and is then saved by Hashem, he should respond by giving שבה and הודאה to Hashem for getting him out of his situation. There are two perspectives of his praise of Hashem. If the עיקר of his שְׁמִיחָה is because Hashem saved him, his שְׁמִיחָה would not be any more than if he had never gotten into trouble in the first place. However, the שְׁמִיחָה at סוף ים סוף was different. The עיקר שְׁמִיחָה of משה רבינו and כלל ישראל wasn't just that הקדוש ברוך הוא saved them from the מצריים. Their primary joy was the realization that through their suffering and redemption, they became the כלי הפנ"י by which Hashem's name was glorified in the world. The הקדוש ברוך הוא was realized through their experiences, including the suffering of מצרים and the subsequent redemption. This is reflected in the שירה: אָשִׁירָה לְה' כִּי גָאֵה גָאֵה: שירה. They sang not just for the הצלה, but also for the שיעבוד which came before. The connection is clear: באז חטאתי - Moshe previously was complaining about the שיעבוד, now he sang שירה to explain that when he said אִזּוֹ then, it was not a complaint, rather, he was thanking Hashem that through the modality of שיעבוד מצרים and גאולת מצרים we became the means by which Hashem's name received greatness in this world. The בית הלוי also explains a phrase we recite in הלל: אֲנִי תִתֵּנִי וְתִתֵּנִי לִי: הַלֵּל. While commonly understood as "Thank You for answering me," אֲנִי תִתֵּנִי actually refers to suffering. - וְתִתֵּנִי לִי לִישׁוּעָה Why? עֵינֵי, for the suffering that I had, Why? - אֲנִי תִתֵּנִי - Hashem, I am praising you for my עֵינֵי, for the suffering that I had, Why? - because I am giving you thanks both on the עֵינֵי which came before, and the ישועה which came afterwards, through which we had the great זכות to be מקדש the name of ברבים.

Are we on such a מדרגה? I don't know about you, but I am not. It takes a tremendous amount of בטחון, and courage to say "Thank you Hashem for all of this pain. I don't know why I'm going through all of this, and yet there's a reason for it." Rarely do we have the opportunity to appreciate what the purpose of it was, in our own limited vision and lifetime, but we will one day understand that all of it was for good. Everything Hashem does is for good, and we just have to have absolute bedrock אמונה that that is the truth.

